DOCK CONSULTING

The TOGAF® Standard

A Visual Companion to the ADM

Inputs, steps, outputs and connections
across the TOGAF® Standard



TOGAF® Standard, 10th Edition
Dock Consulting / Edition 0.7

PUBLICATION INFORMATION

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FIND YOUR WAY

Contents

Each phase combines official objectives, essential purpose and a brief approach with its two views.

Start with the reading guide and colour key. Then follow the phase sections or revisit a specific topic. Each section combines quoted objectives and essential purpose with a brief approach summary.

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to use this guide

Use the diagrams to understand the flow of work and find the supporting TOGAF® guidance.

What the guide covers

This companion follows the Preliminary Phase, Phases A to H, and Requirements Management. Phase C is shown as separate Data and Application Architecture topics. The two are coordinated parts of the same phase. The official objectives are reproduced from the ADM publication. The purpose distinguishes essential output and outcome from the knowledge required to deliver it.

A useful reading sequence

Read the official objectives, purpose and brief approach together. Trace inputs through the steps to the outputs. Use the relationship view to locate supporting guidance. The same item can be an output in one phase and an input in another.

The ADM is iterative

The phase order gives structure to architecture development. Work can iterate within a phase, between phases and across cycles. Tailor the scope, level of detail and use of the method to the situation. Requirements Management remains active throughout the relevant architecture work.

How to interpret the model

The views use ArchiMate shapes and icons to organise the material. Connections in the relationship views are modelled reading links; they do not claim to show every dependency or prescribe an execution sequence. A phase is useful when its required outcome or knowledge is needed; existing suitable work can be reused.

TWO DIFFERENT COLOUR SYSTEMS

Reading the two views

Colours answer different questions in the two diagram families.

Inputs, steps and outputs

INPUTS What is available to inform the work.

STEPS The activities carried out in the phase.

OUTPUTS What the work produces or updates.

Colour follows the role in this view. All inputs share the input colour and all outputs share the output colour, whatever their source book.

Relationship views

- ADM
- Architecture Content
- ADM Techniques
- Applying the ADM
- Capability and Governance
- TOGAF® Series Guides

Here colour identifies the book or book family. Lighter nested shapes remain in the same colour family.

01 / PRELIMINARY

Preliminary Phase

Establish the capability, principles and governance needed to undertake architecture work.

Official objectives

1. Determine the Architecture Capability desired by the organization:
    - Review the organizational context for conducting Enterprise Architecture
    - Identify and scope the elements of the enterprise organizations affected by the Architecture Capability
    - Identify the established frameworks, methods, and processes that intersect with the Architecture Capability
    - Establish Capability Maturity target
2. Establish the Architecture Capability:
    - Define and establish the Organizational Model for Enterprise Architecture
    - Define and establish the detailed process and resources for Architecture Governance
    - Select and implement tools that support the Architecture Capability
    - Define the Architecture Principles

Purpose

Essential output and outcome

An established Architecture Capability: organisational arrangements, governance, principles, a tailored framework and an initial repository that enable architecture work suited to the enterprise.

Essential knowledge

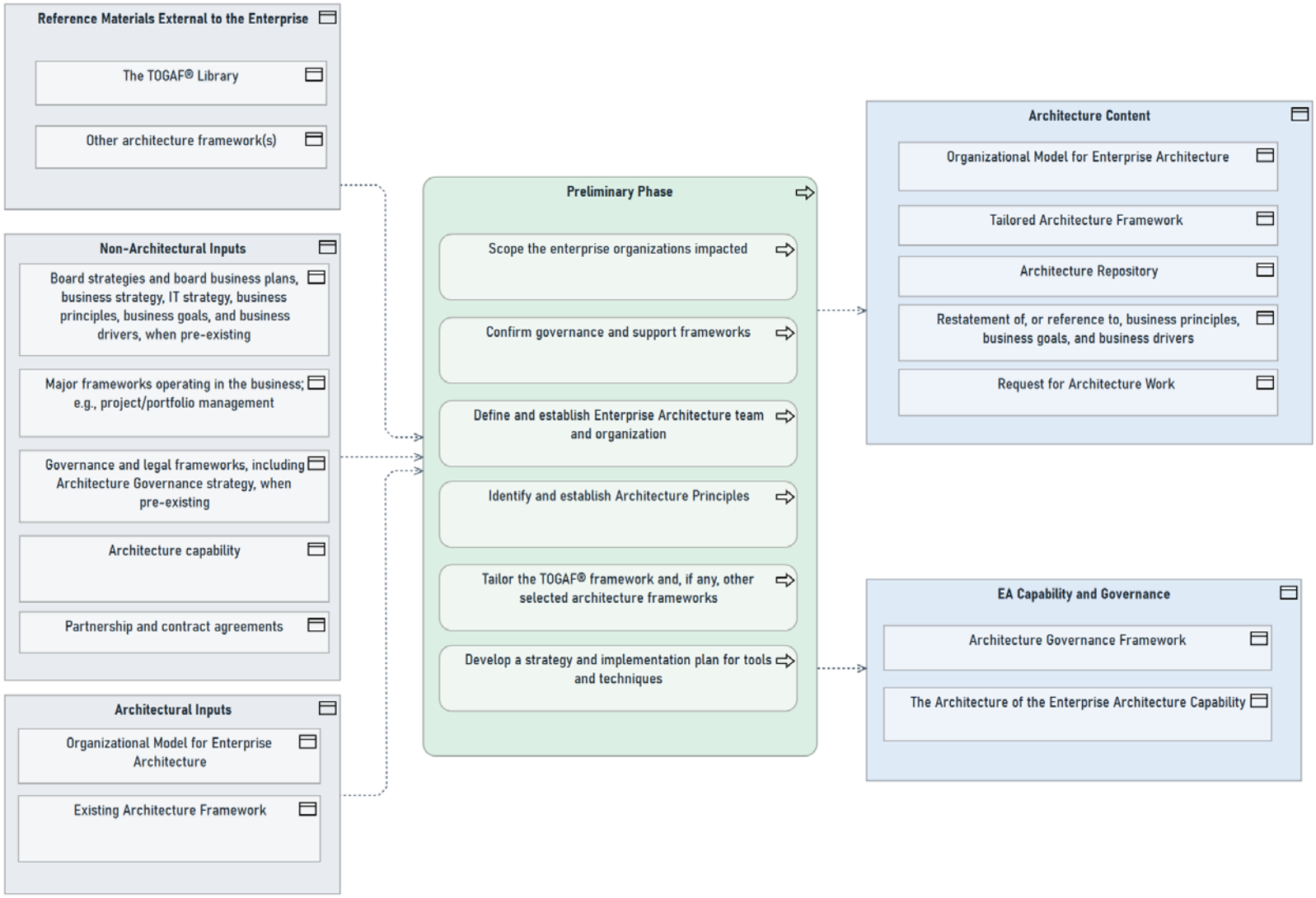
Know the enterprise boundary, drivers, stakeholders, culture, management frameworks, maturity, skills and resources. Use this context to determine the capability required.

Approach in brief

Define the enterprise, organisational context and requirements for architecture work. Establish principles, tailor the framework and its relationships with other management frameworks, and evaluate maturity. Treat the Architecture Capability itself as an architecture subject; revisit it when an engagement needs a different capability.

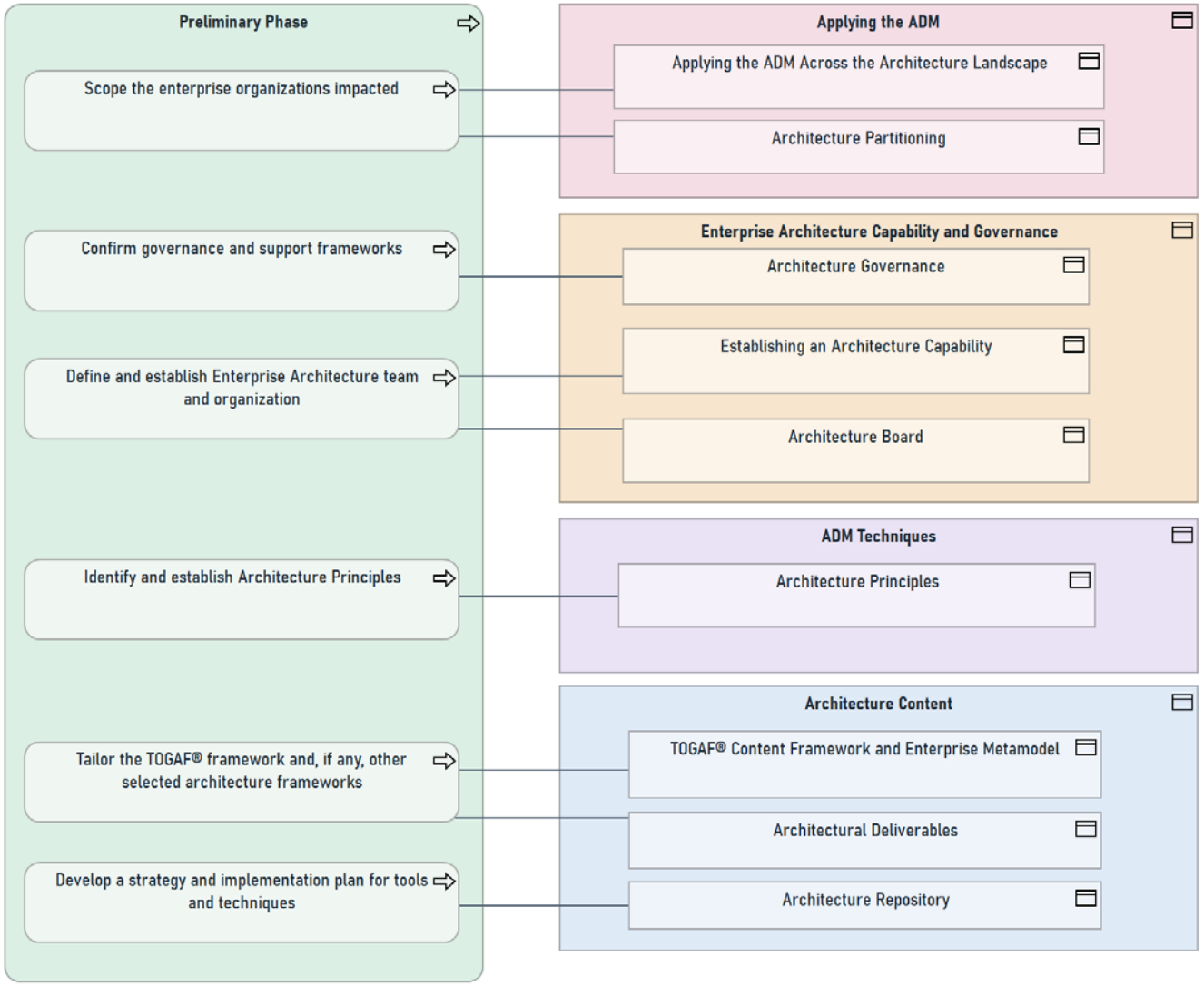
Preliminary Phase | Inputs, steps and outputs

Read from inputs through the phase steps to outputs. Colours identify roles within this view.



Preliminary Phase | Relationships

Follow the modelled connections to related techniques, content and governance. Colours identify books.



02 / PHASE A

Architecture Vision

Agree the value, scope and direction of the architecture engagement.

Official objectives

• Develop a high-level aspirational vision of the capabilities and business value to be delivered as a result of the proposed Enterprise Architecture

• Obtain approval for a Statement of Architecture Work that defines a program of works to develop and deploy the architecture outlined in the Architecture Vision

Purpose

Essential output and outcome

Sufficient documentation to get permission to proceed.
Permission to proceed to develop a Target Architecture to prove out a summary target.

Essential knowledge

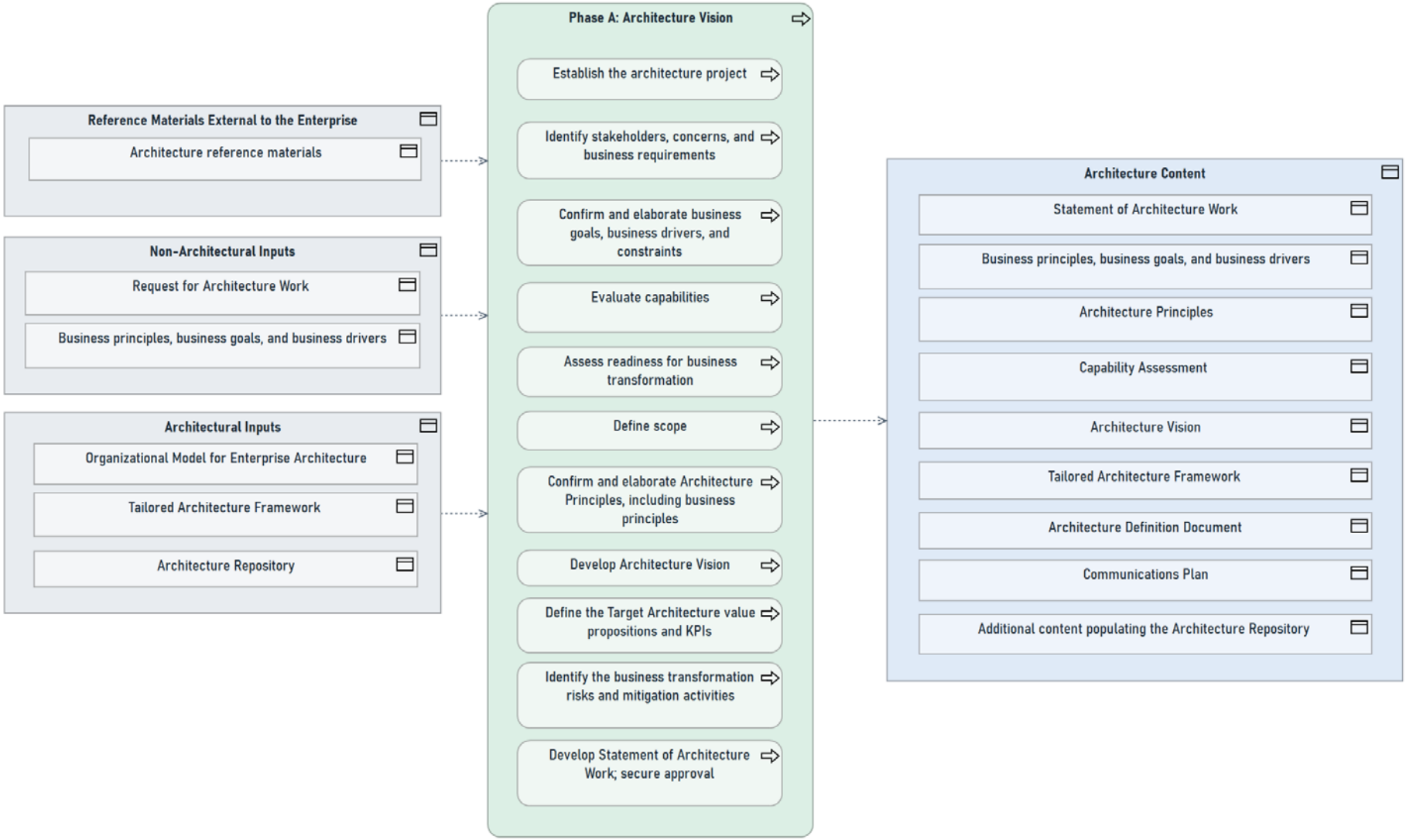
The scope of the problem being addressed.
Those who have interests that are fundamental to the problem being addressed. (Stakeholders & Concerns)
What summary answer to the problem is acceptable to the stakeholders? (Architecture Vision)
Stakeholder priority and preference.
What value does the summary answer provide?

Approach in brief

Establish sponsorship and scope within realistic resource and competence limits. Validate business goals and principles. Develop a high-level baseline and target vision, and build consensus through approval of the Statement of Architecture Work. Revisit Preliminary if the framework cannot support the engagement.

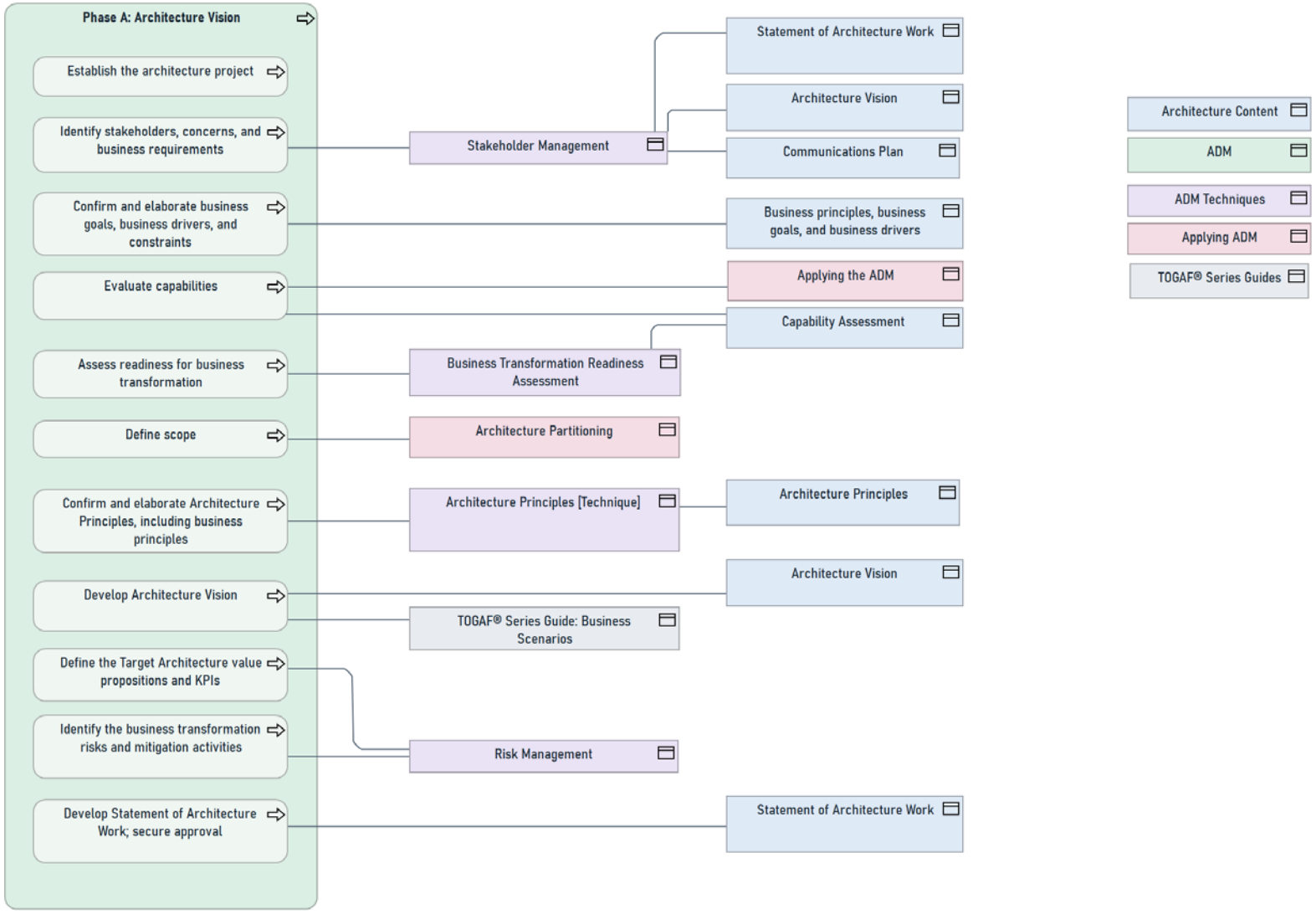
Architecture Vision | Inputs, steps and outputs

Read from inputs through the phase steps to outputs. Colours identify roles within this view.



Architecture Vision | Relationships

Follow the modelled connections to related techniques, content and governance. Colours identify books.



03 / PHASE B

Business Architecture

Describe how the enterprise needs to operate to achieve the agreed outcomes.

Official objectives

• Develop the Target Business Architecture that describes how the enterprise needs to operate to achieve the business goals, and respond to the strategic drivers set out in the Architecture Vision, in a way that addresses the Statement of Architecture Work and stakeholder concerns

• Identify candidate Architecture Roadmap components based upon gaps between the Baseline and Target Business Architectures

Purpose

Essential output and outcome

A set of domain architectures approved by the stakeholders for the problem being addressed, with a set of gaps, and work to clear the gaps understood by the stakeholders.

Essential knowledge

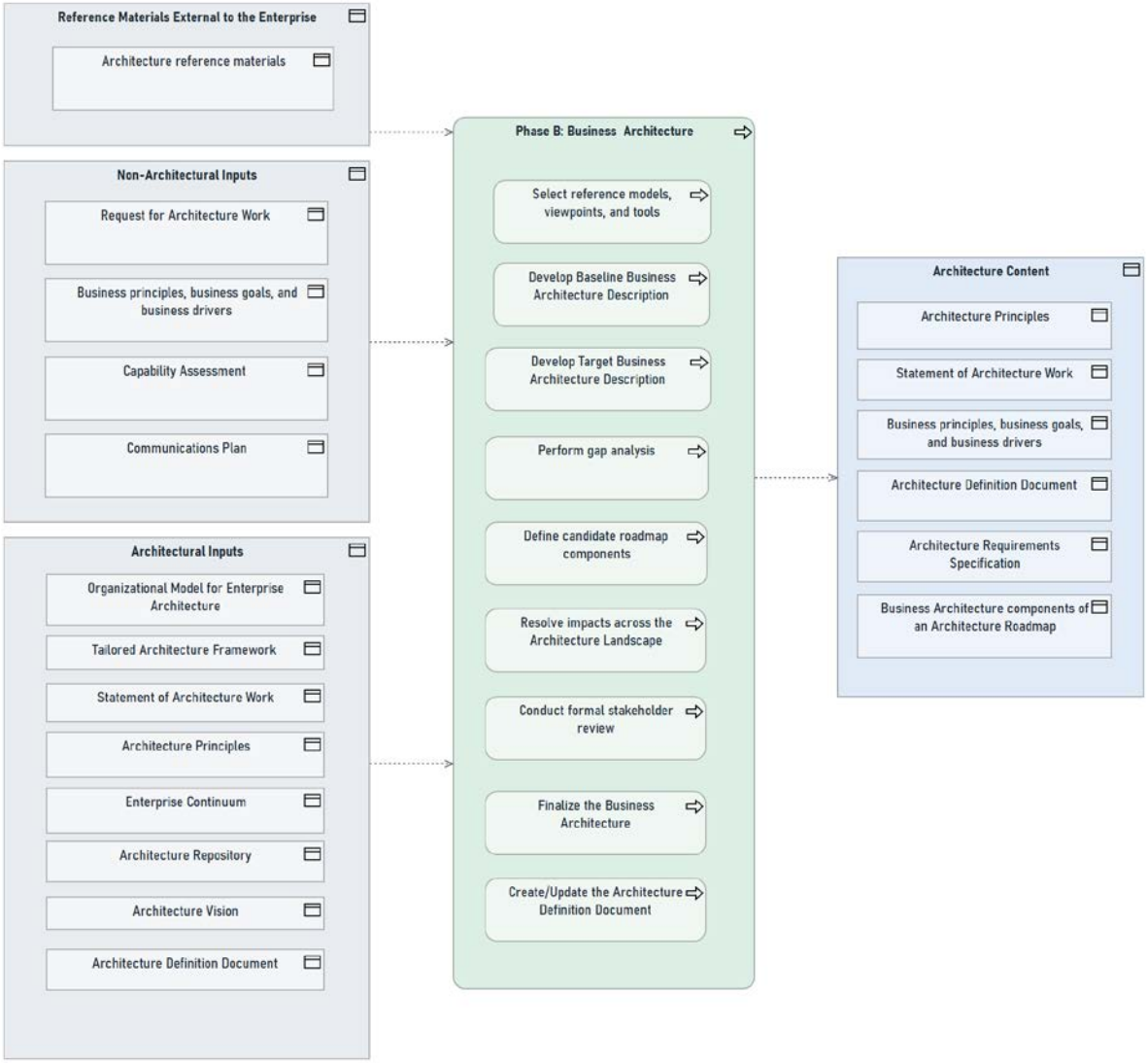
How does the current Enterprise fail to meet the preferences of the stakeholders?
What must change to enable the Enterprise to meet the preferences of the stakeholders? (Gaps)
What work is necessary to realize the changes, that is consistent with the additional value being created? (Work Package)
How stakeholder priority and preference adjust in response to value, effort, and risk of change. (Stakeholder Requirements)

Approach in brief

Use the Architecture Vision to set scope. Reuse and verify existing business descriptions, developing missing material where necessary. Apply capability, value-stream, organisation and information views where relevant. Gather only the detail needed for decisions and use suitable repository material.

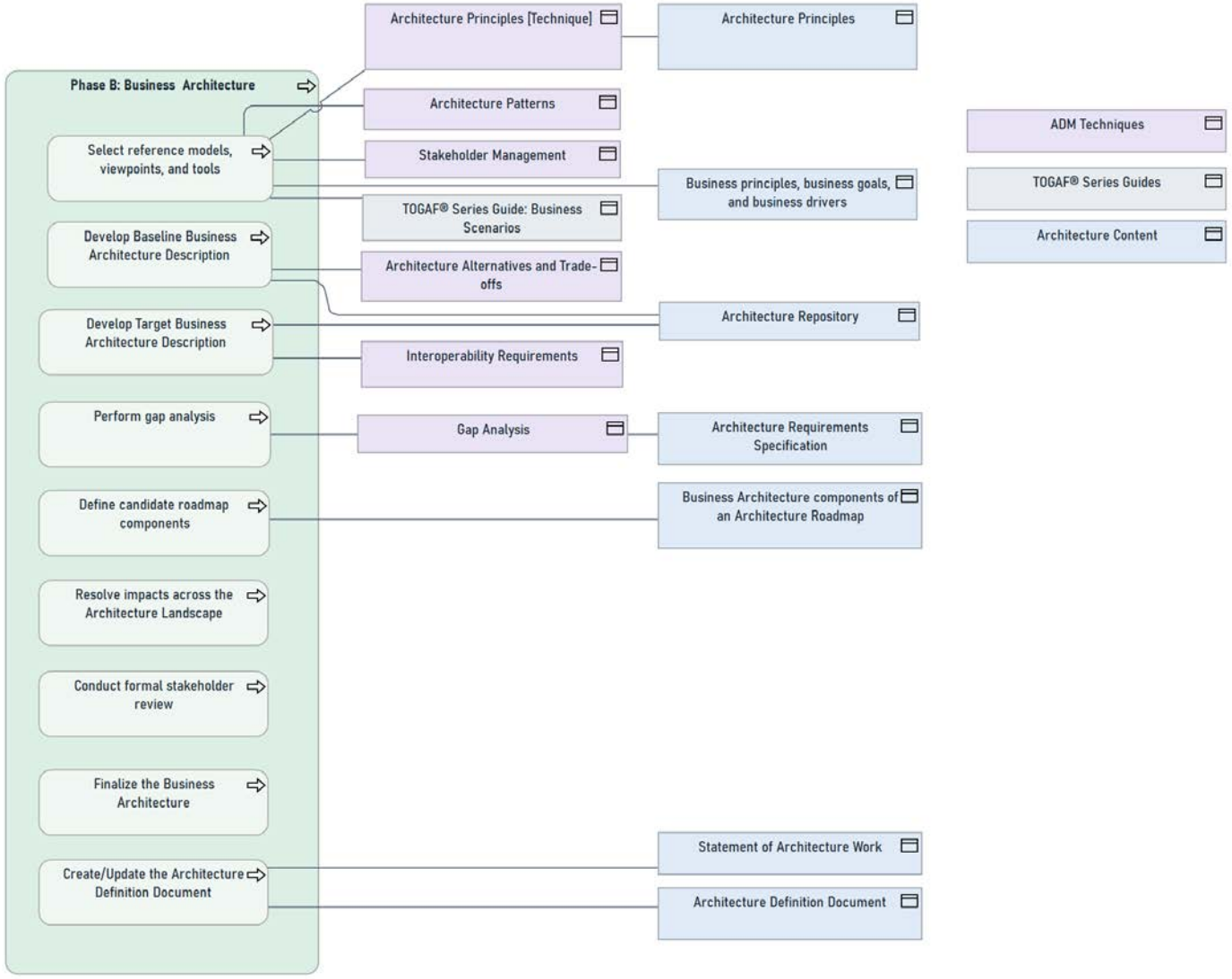
Business Architecture | Inputs, steps and outputs

Read from inputs through the phase steps to outputs. Colours identify roles within this view.



Business Architecture | Relationships

Follow the modelled connections to related techniques, content and governance. Colours identify books.



04 / PHASE C / DATA

Data Architecture

Determine the data needed to support the business and the Architecture Vision.

Official objectives

• Develop the Target Data Architecture that enables the Business Architecture and the Architecture Vision, in a way that addresses the Statement of Architecture Work and stakeholder concerns

• Identify candidate Architecture Roadmap components based upon gaps between the Baseline and Target Data Architectures

Purpose

Essential output and outcome

A set of domain architectures approved by the stakeholders for the problem being addressed, with a set of gaps, and work to clear the gaps understood by the stakeholders.

Essential knowledge

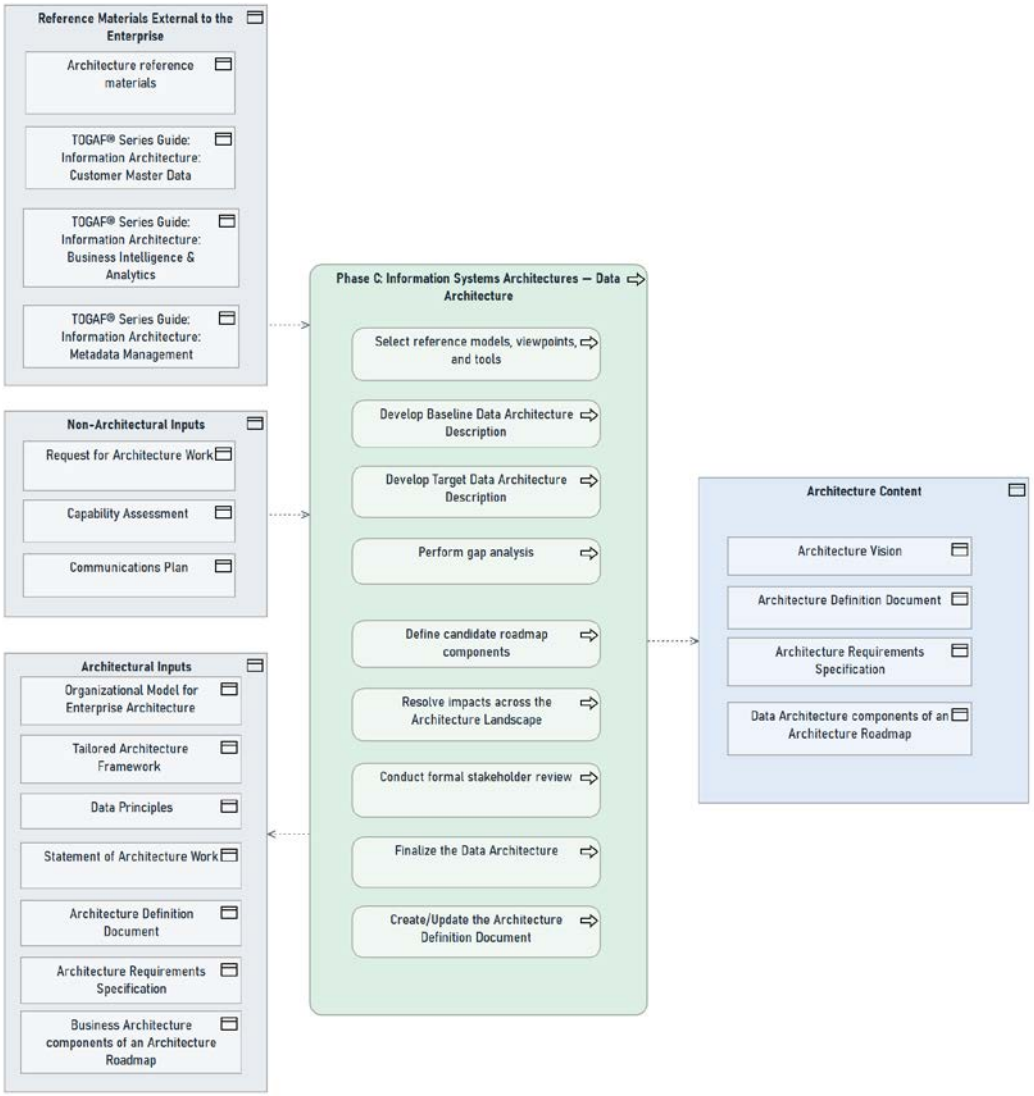
How does the current Enterprise fail to meet the preferences of the stakeholders?
What must change to enable the Enterprise to meet the preferences of the stakeholders? (Gaps)
What work is necessary to realize the changes, that is consistent with the additional value being created? (Work Package)
How stakeholder priority and preference adjust in response to value, effort, and risk of change. (Stakeholder Requirements)

Approach in brief

Address data at rest, in motion, in use and, where relevant, open data. Use conceptual, logical and physical descriptions as needed. Consider data management, migration and governance, including authoritative sources, ownership, sharing and quality. Coordinate data choices with application responsibilities and repository resources.

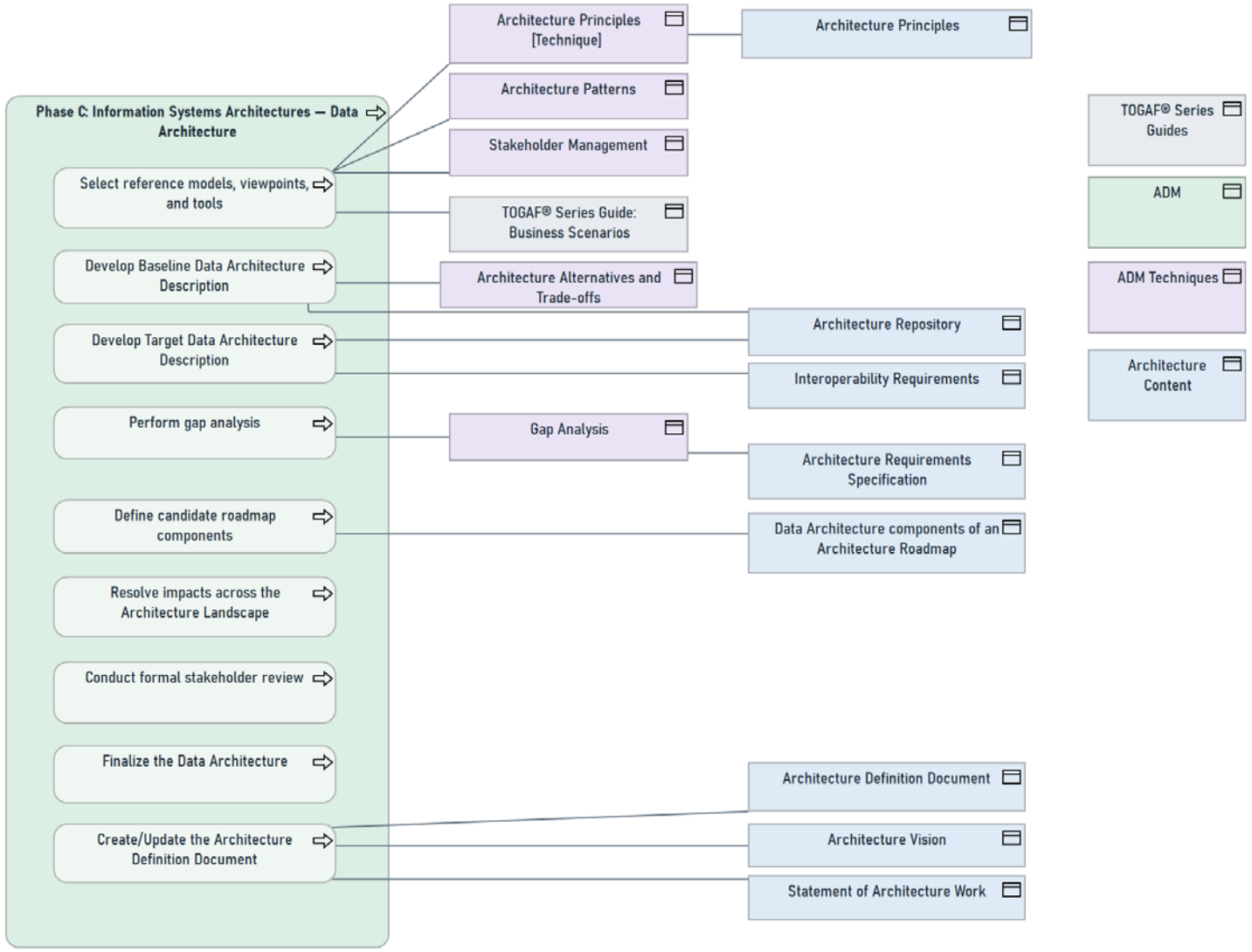
Data Architecture | Inputs, steps and outputs

Read from inputs through the phase steps to outputs. Colours identify roles within this view.



Data Architecture | Relationships

Follow the modelled connections to related techniques, content and governance. Colours identify books.



05 / PHASE C / APPLICATION

Application Architecture

Define the application services and interactions needed to support the business.

Official objectives

• Develop the Target Application Architecture that enables the Business Architecture and the Architecture Vision, in a way that addresses the Statement of Architecture Work and stakeholder concerns

• Identify candidate Architecture Roadmap components based upon gaps between the Baseline and Target Application Architectures

Purpose

Essential output and outcome

A set of domain architectures approved by the stakeholders for the problem being addressed, with a set of gaps, and work to clear the gaps understood by the stakeholders.

Essential knowledge

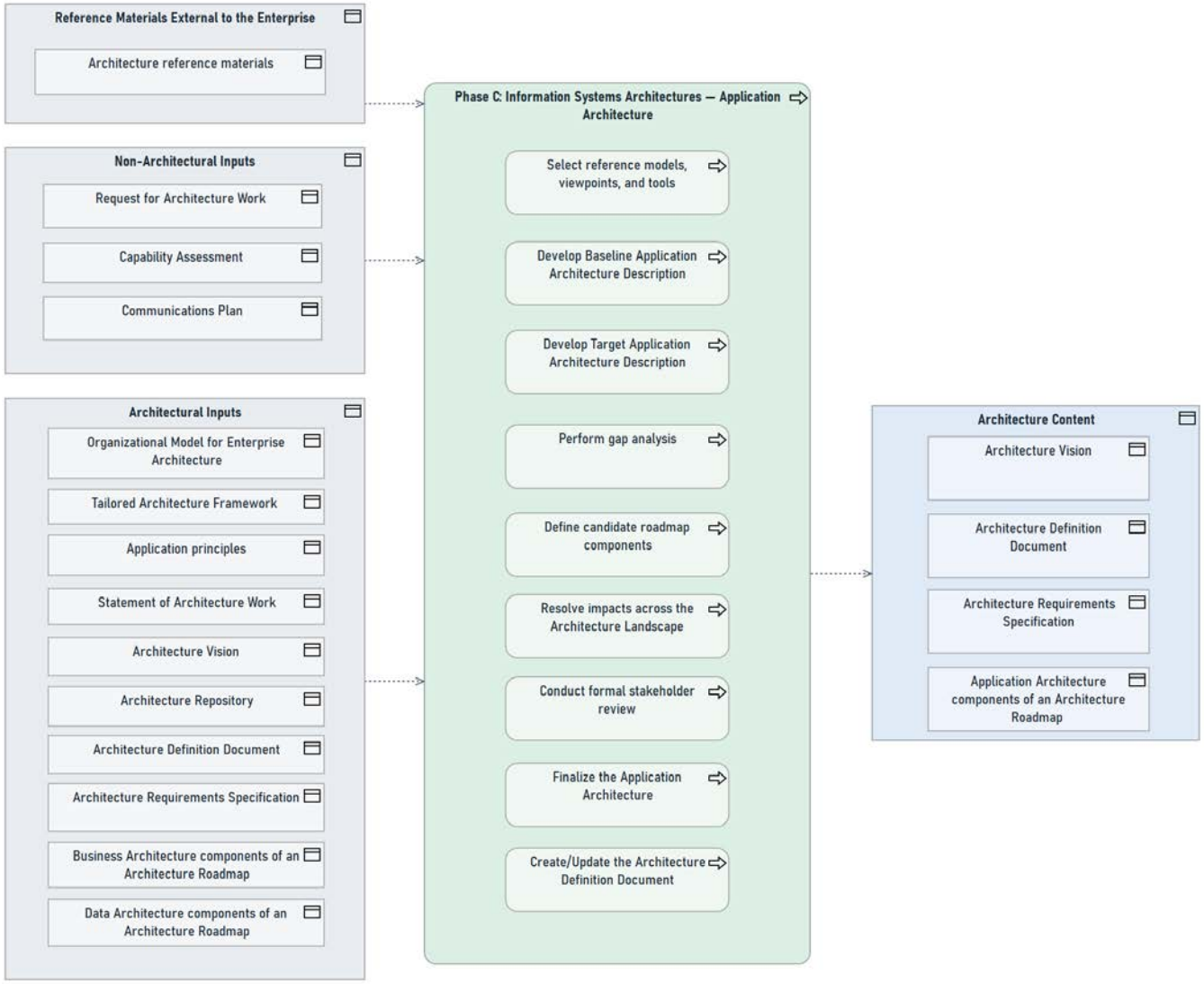
How does the current Enterprise fail to meet the preferences of the stakeholders?
What must change to enable the Enterprise to meet the preferences of the stakeholders? (Gaps)
What work is necessary to realize the changes, that is consistent with the additional value being created? (Work Package)
How stakeholder priority and preference adjust in response to value, effort, and risk of change. (Stakeholder Requirements)

Approach in brief

Review relevant Application Architecture resources in the repository: industry business models with related application models, and models for common high-level functions. Consider integrated-information-infrastructure guidance where relevant. Apply reusable material within the engagement's scope rather than adopting a reference model as the target by default.

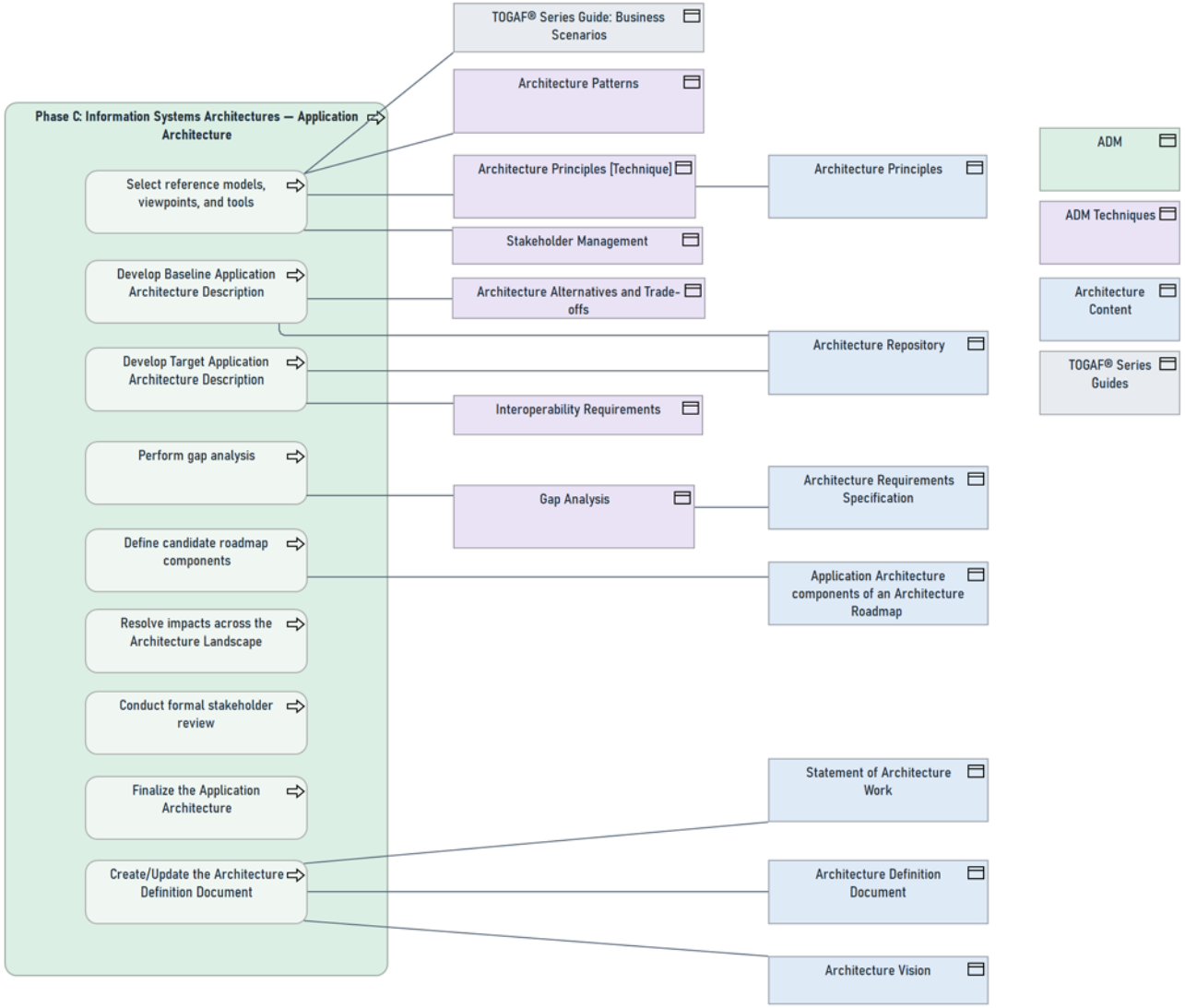
Application Architecture | Inputs, steps and outputs

Read from inputs through the phase steps to outputs. Colours identify roles within this view.



Application Architecture | Relationships

Follow the modelled connections to related techniques, content and governance. Colours identify books.



06 / PHASE D

Technology Architecture

Identify the technology services and components needed to realise the target architectures.

Official objectives

• Develop the Target Technology Architecture that enables the Architecture Vision, target business, data, and application building blocks to be delivered through technology components and technology services, in a way that addresses the Statement of Architecture Work and stakeholder concerns

• Identify candidate Architecture Roadmap components based upon gaps between the Baseline and Target Technology Architectures

Purpose

Essential output and outcome

A set of domain architectures approved by the stakeholders for the problem being addressed, with a set of gaps, and work to clear the gaps understood by the stakeholders.

Essential knowledge

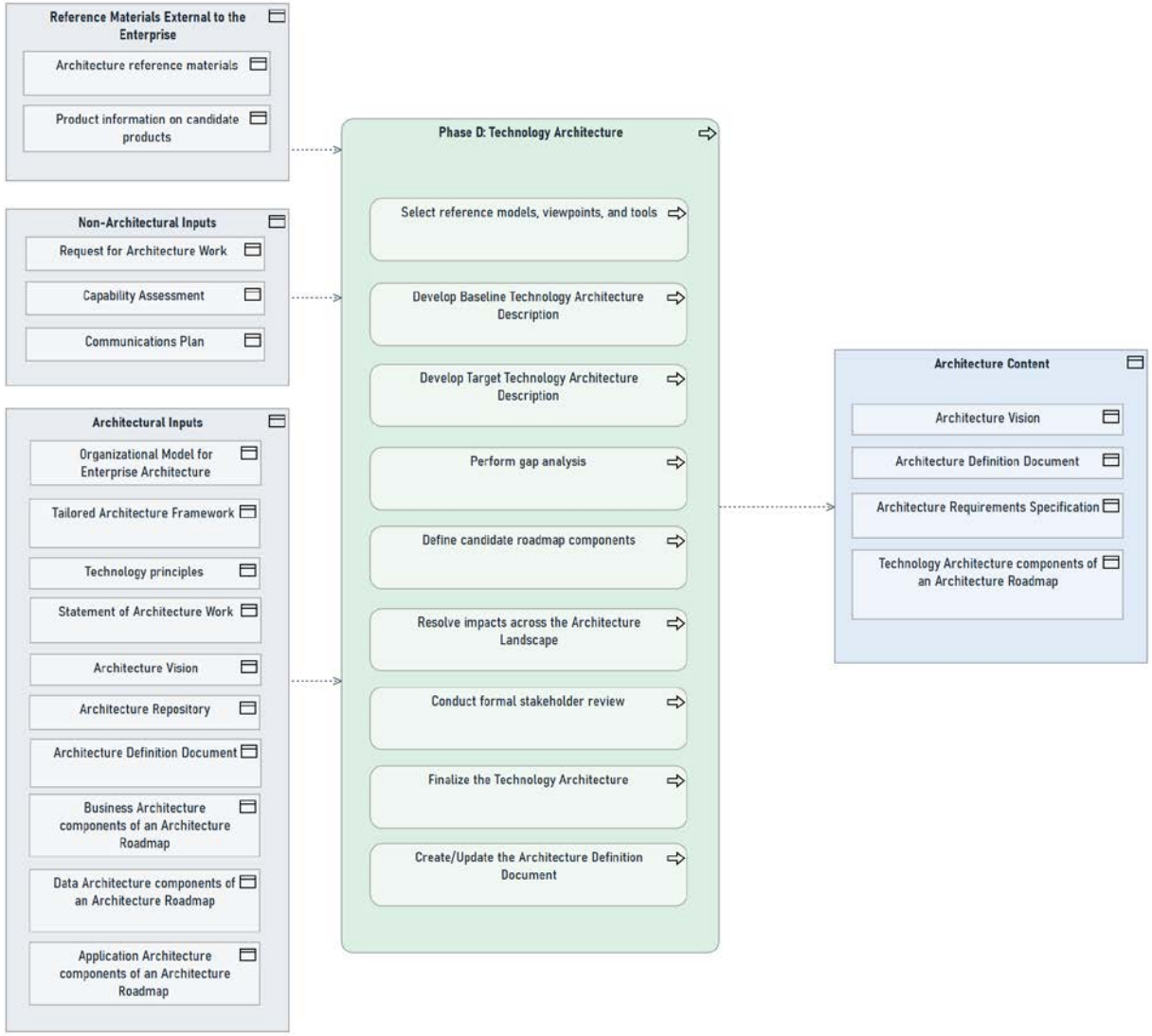
How does the current Enterprise fail to meet the preferences of the stakeholders?
What must change to enable the Enterprise to meet the preferences of the stakeholders? (Gaps)
What work is necessary to realize the changes, that is consistent with the additional value being created? (Work Package)
How stakeholder priority and preference adjust in response to value, effort, and risk of change. (Stakeholder Requirements)

Approach in brief

Consider emerging technology as a source of business opportunity as well as a response to information-system requirements. Assess it within a coherent architecture. Review existing IT services, adopted technical reference models and relevant industry or common-systems models to support the technology services and components required.

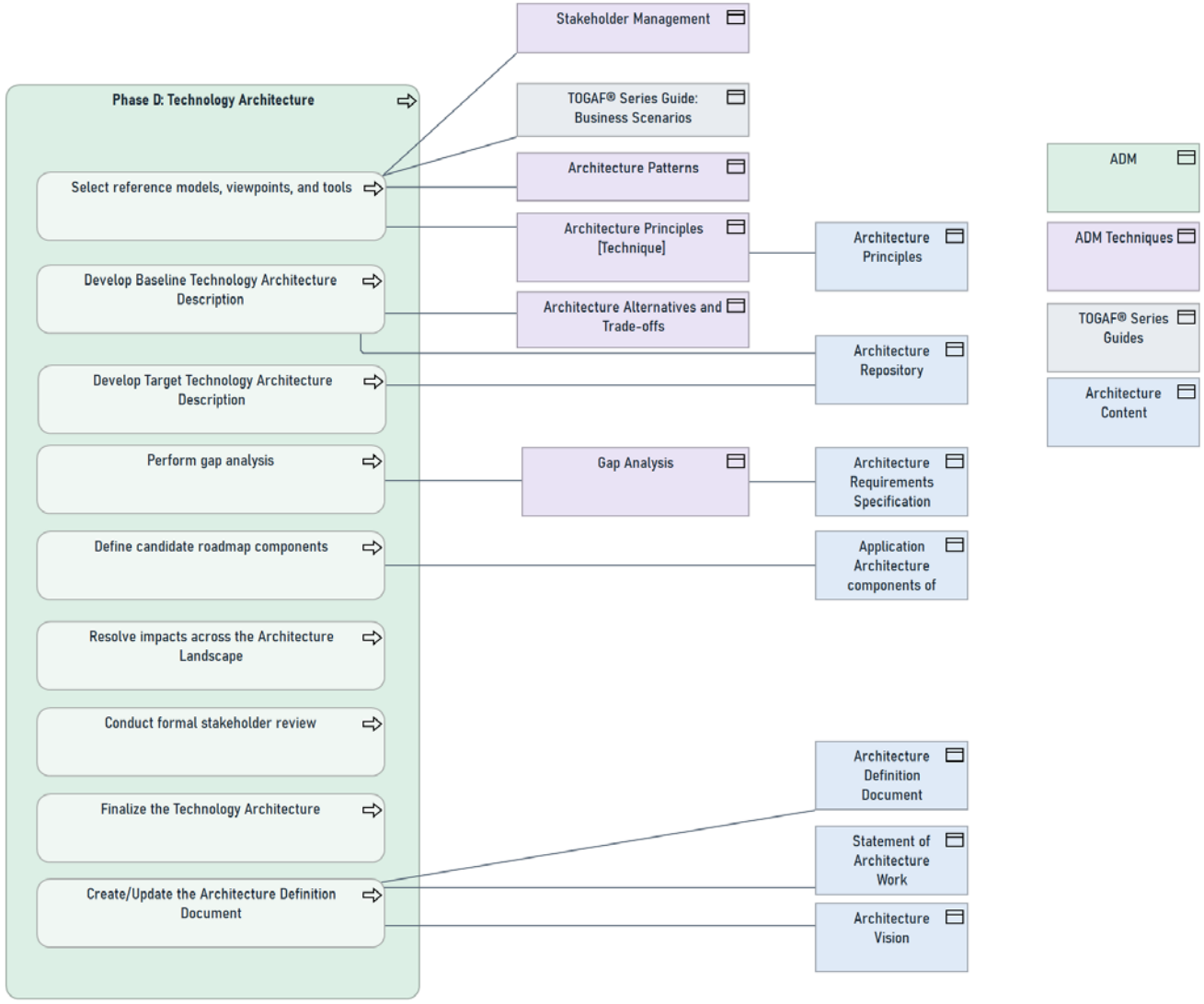
Technology Architecture | Inputs, steps and outputs

Read from inputs through the phase steps to outputs. Colours identify roles within this view.



Technology Architecture | Relationships

Follow the modelled connections to related techniques, content and governance. Colours identify books.



07 / PHASE E

Opportunities and Solutions

Combine the domain changes into a coherent approach to implementation.

Official objectives

• Generate the initial complete version of the Architecture Roadmap, based upon the gap analysis and candidate Architecture Roadmap components from Phases B, C, and D

• Determine whether an incremental approach is required, and if so identify Transition Architectures that will deliver continuous business value

• Define the overall Solution Building Blocks (SBBs) to finalize the Target Architecture based on the ABBs

Purpose

Essential output and outcome

A set of work packages that address the set of gaps, with an indication of value produced and effort required, and dependencies between the work packages to reach the adjusted target.

Essential knowledge

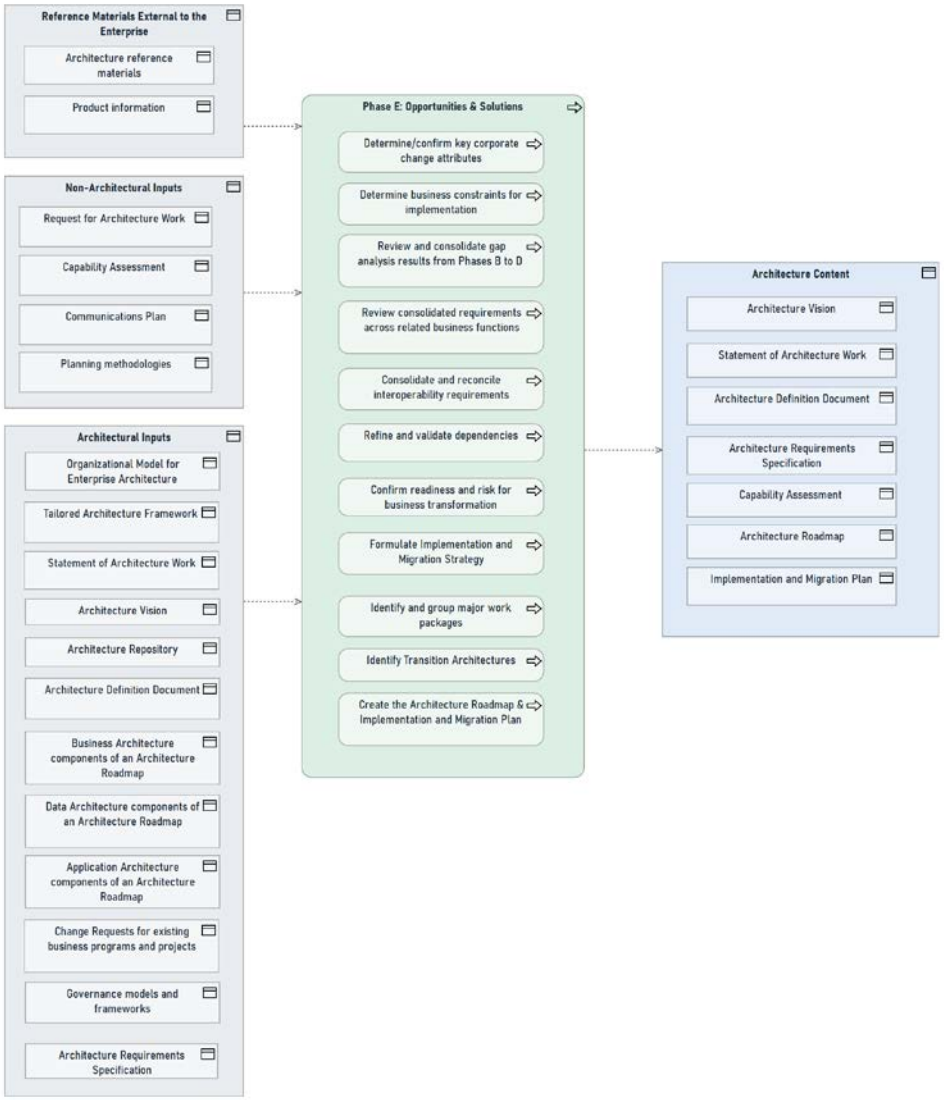
Dependency between the set of changes. (Work Package & Gap dependency)
Value, effort, and risk associated with each change and work package.
How stakeholder priority and preference adjust in response to value, effort, and risk of change.

Approach in brief

Consolidate domain gaps into work packages within enterprise portfolios. Build a best-fit roadmap informed by requirements, readiness, opportunities and implementation constraints. Keep the target in view while delivering incremental value. Use work packages and Transition Architectures to form the initial Implementation and Migration Plan.

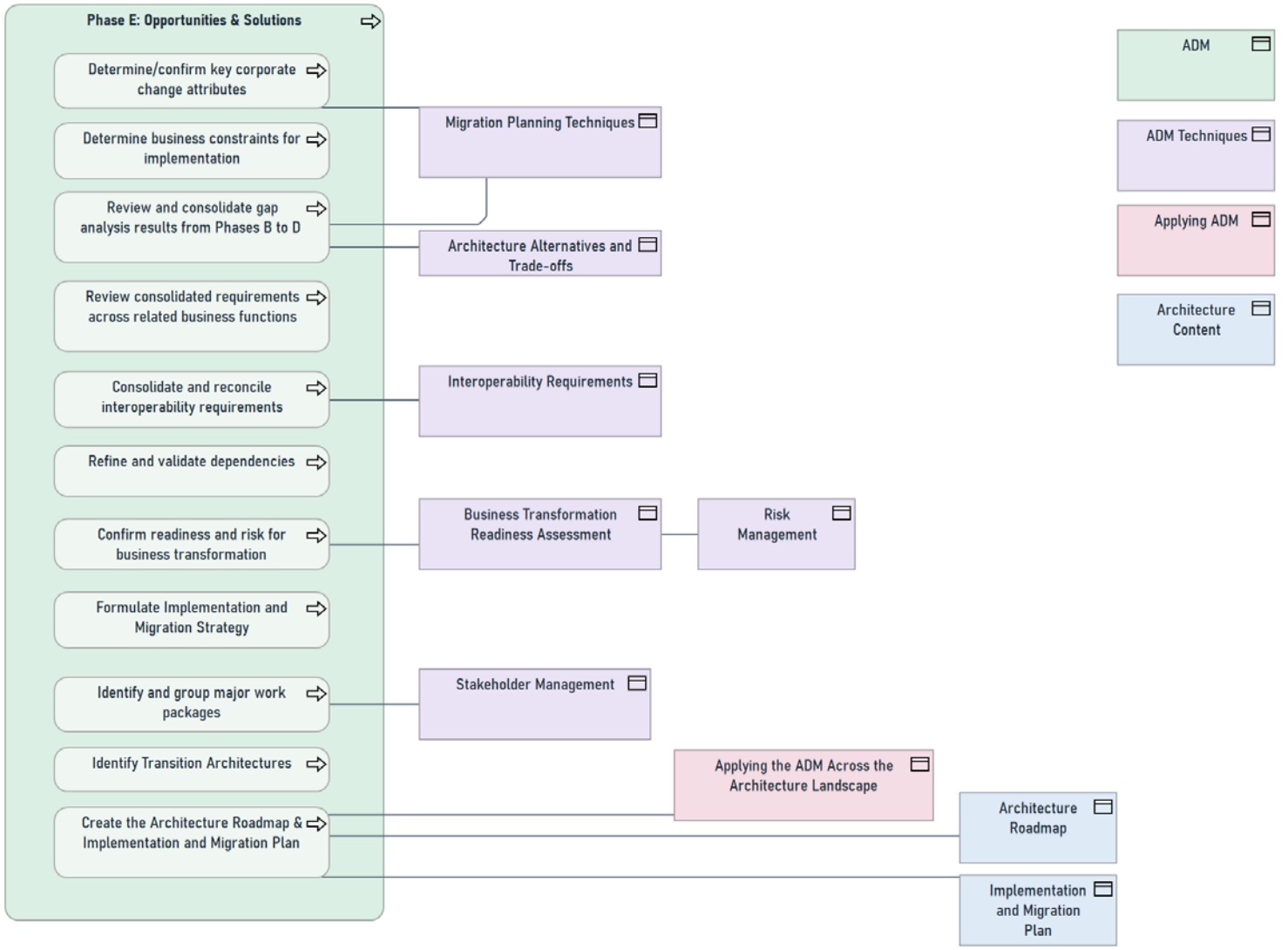
Opportunities and Solutions | Inputs, steps and outputs

Read from inputs through the phase steps to outputs. Colours identify roles within this view.



Opportunities and Solutions | Relationships

Follow the modelled connections to related techniques, content and governance. Colours identify books.



08 / PHASE F

Migration Planning

Prioritise the change and agree a practical roadmap and migration plan.

Official objectives

• Finalize the Architecture Roadmap and the supporting Implementation and Migration Plan

• Ensure that the Implementation and Migration Plan is co-ordinated with the enterprise's approach to managing and implementing change in the enterprise's overall change portfolio

• Ensure that the business value and cost of work packages and Transition Architectures is understood by key stakeholders

Purpose

Essential output and outcome

An approved set of projects,[5] containing the objective and any necessary constraints, resources required, and start and finish dates.

Essential knowledge

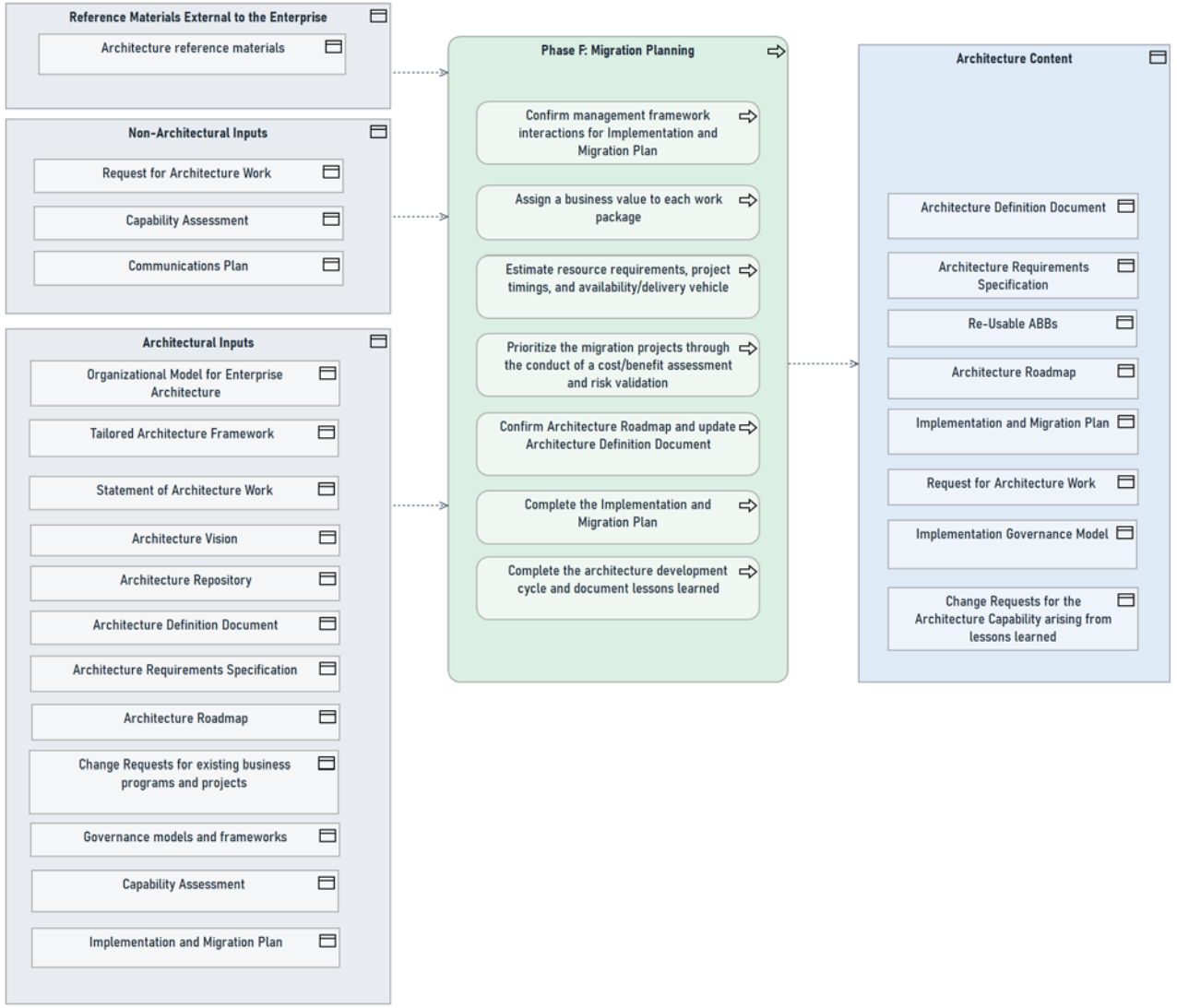
Resources available to undertake the change.
How stakeholder priority and preference adjust in response to value, effort, and risk of change. (Stakeholder Requirements)

Approach in brief

Develop the Implementation and Migration Plan with project and portfolio managers. Integrate the Phase E roadmap and plan with other enterprise change. Assess dependencies, costs and benefits, finalise portfolio and project detail, and complete the architecture development cycle with lessons learned.

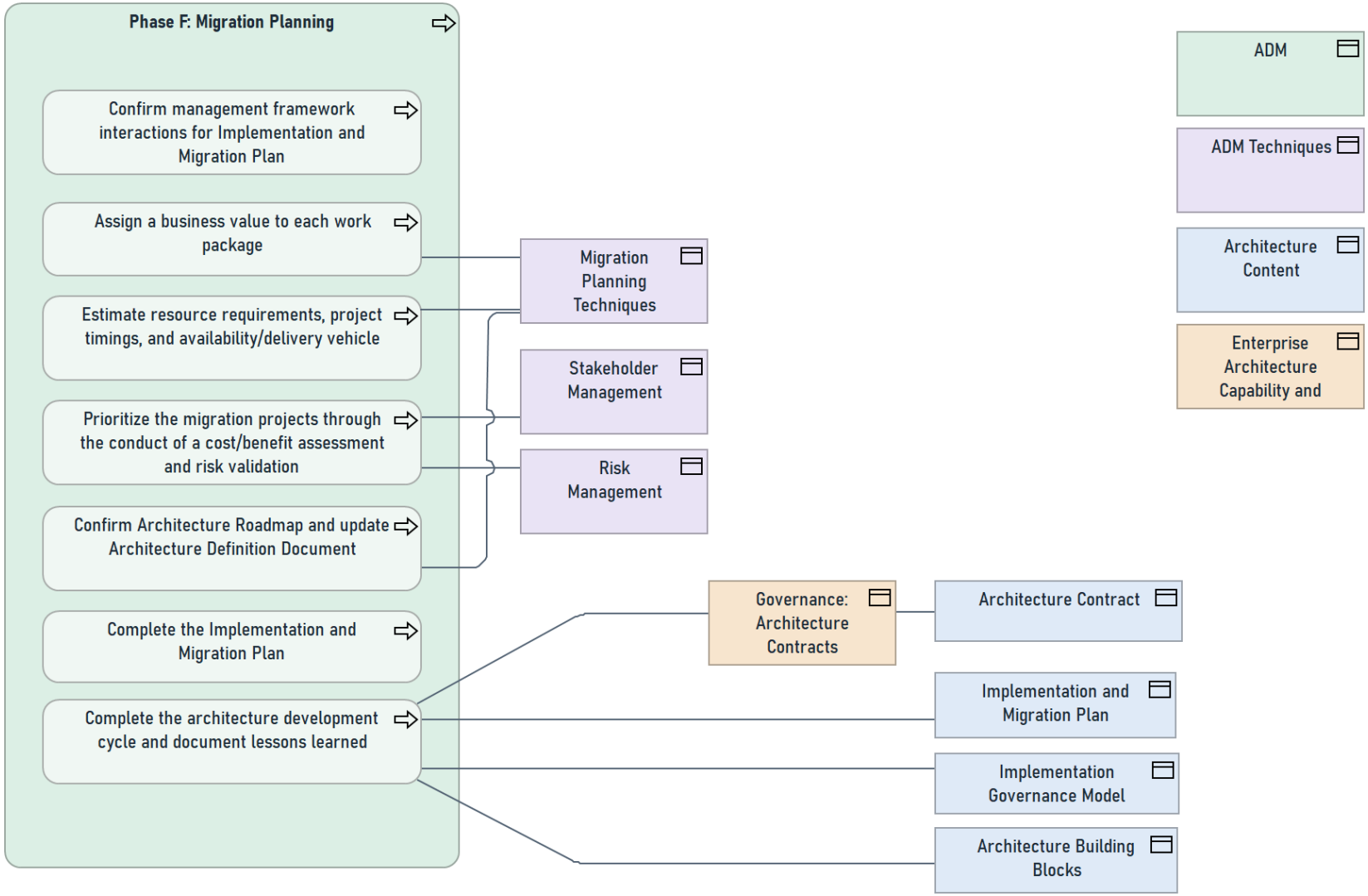
Migration Planning | Inputs, steps and outputs

Read from inputs through the phase steps to outputs. Colours identify roles within this view.



Migration Planning | Relationships

Follow the modelled connections to related techniques, content and governance. Colours identify books.



09 / PHASE G

Implementation Governance

Guide implementation and assess its conformance with the Target Architecture.

Official objectives

• Ensure conformance with the Target Architecture by implementation projects

• Perform appropriate Architecture Governance functions for the solution and any implementation-driven architecture Change Requests

Purpose

Essential output and outcome

Completion of the projects to implement the changes necessary to reach the adjusted target state.

Essential knowledge

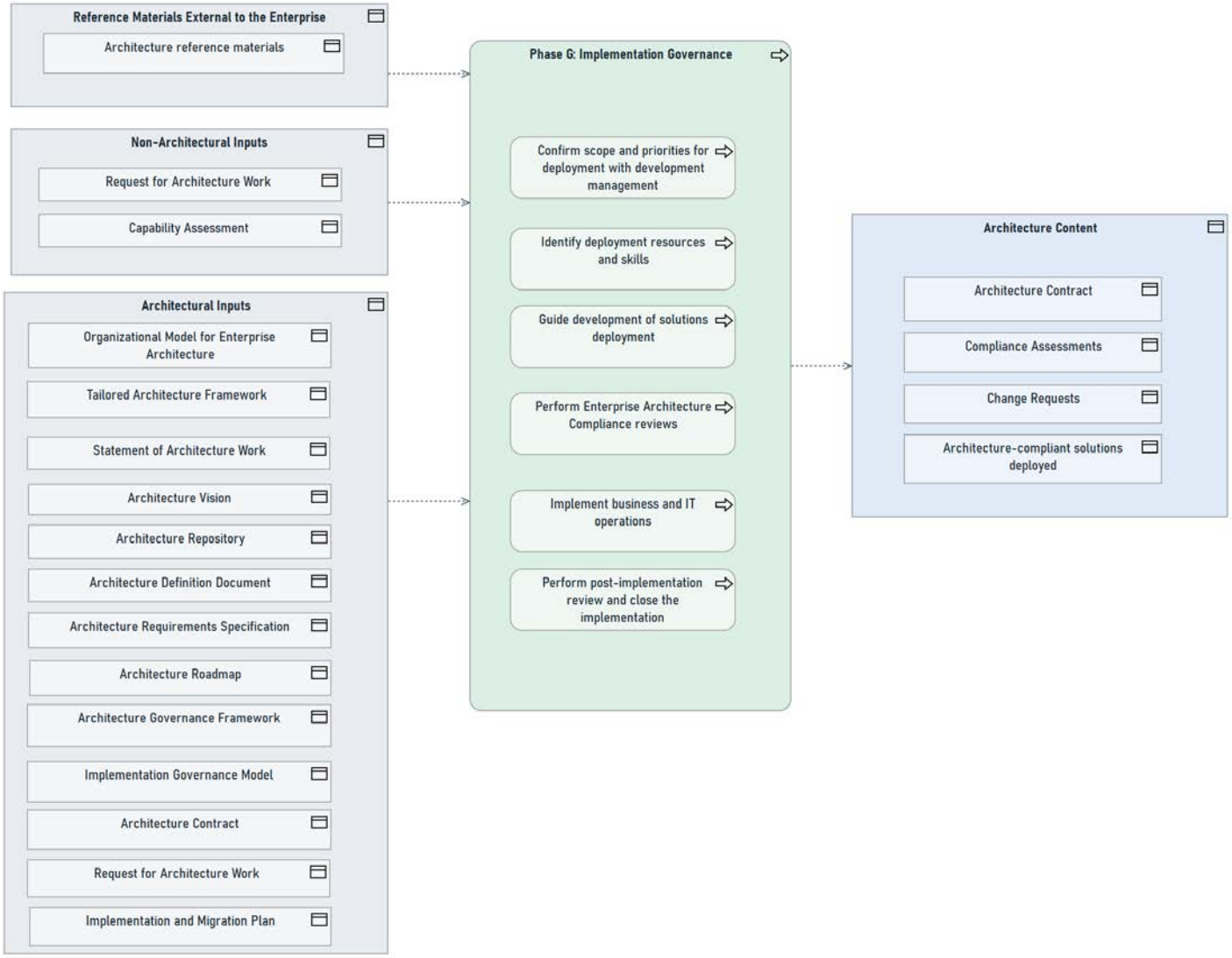
Purpose and constraints on the implementation team. (Gap, Architecture Requirement Specification, Control)
How stakeholder priority and preference adjust in response to success, value, effort, and risk of change. (Stakeholder Requirements)

Approach in brief

Govern implementation while the organisation’s development process runs in parallel. Favour beneficial transitions and a deployment sequence reflecting roadmap priorities. Apply established governance and portfolio or programme management, define the operations framework, and connect architecture to implementation through the Architecture Contract.

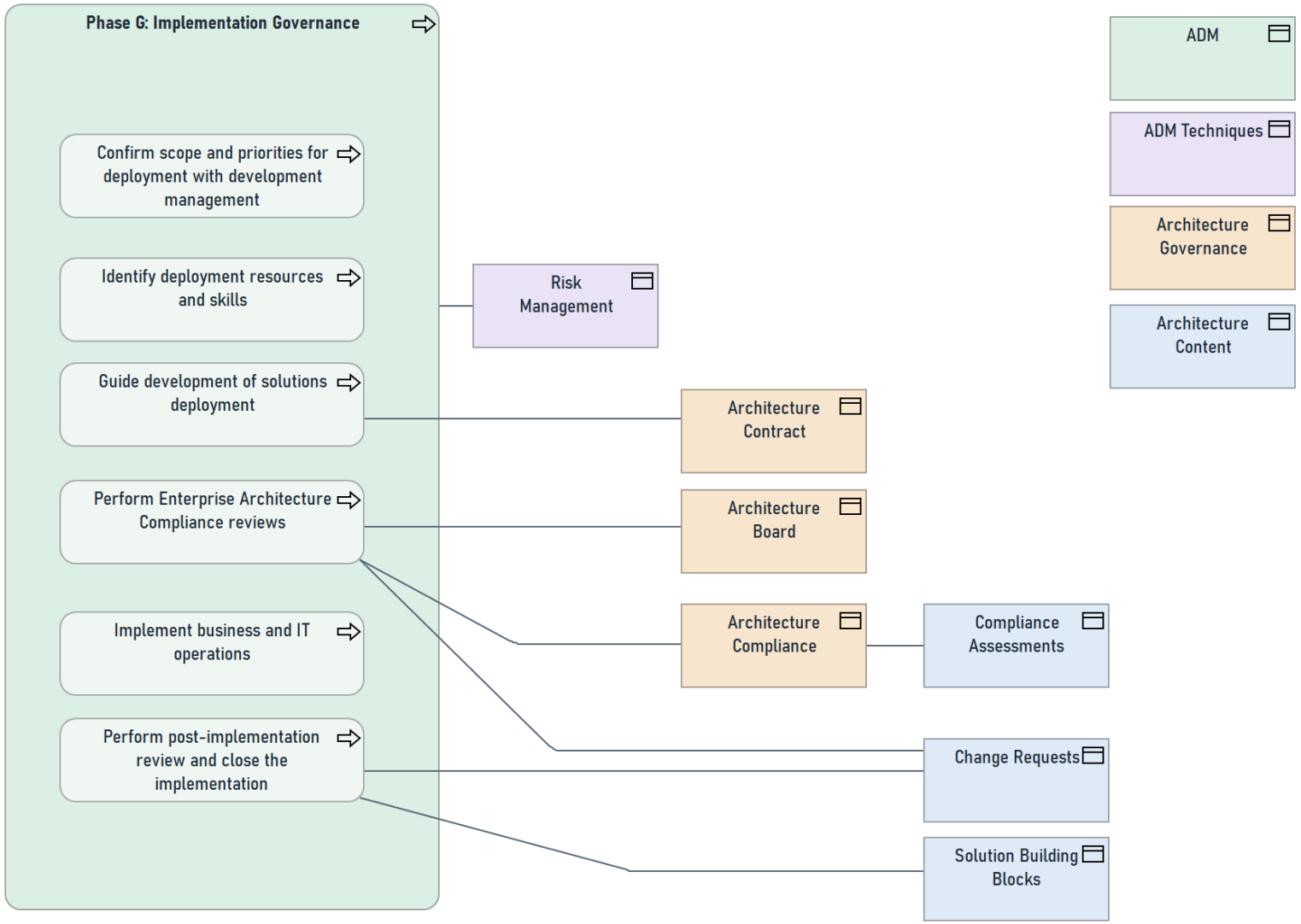
Implementation Governance | Inputs, steps and outputs

Read from inputs through the phase steps to outputs. Colours identify roles within this view.



Implementation Governance | Relationships

Follow the modelled connections to related techniques, content and governance. Colours identify books.



Architecture Change Management

Keep the architecture relevant as the enterprise and its environment change.

Official objectives

- Ensure that the architecture development cycle is maintained
- Ensure that the Architecture Governance Framework is executed
- Ensure that the Enterprise Architecture Capability meets current requirements

Purpose

Essential output and outcome

Direction to proceed and start developing a Target Architecture that addresses perceived, real, or anticipated shortfalls in the Enterprise relative to stakeholder preferences.

Essential knowledge

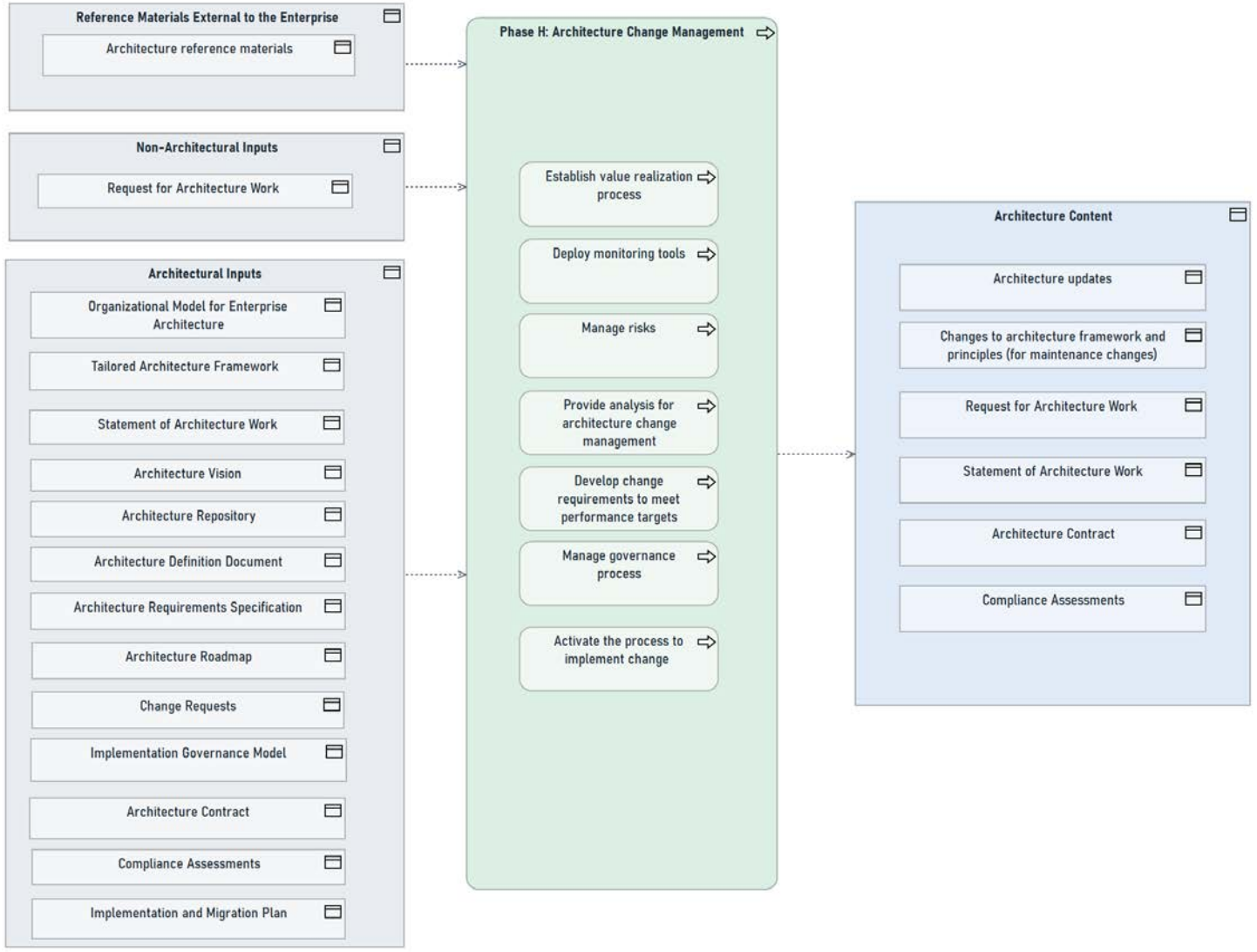
Gaps between approved target, or preference, and realization from prior work. (Value Realization)
Changes in preference or priority. (Stakeholder Requirements)

Approach in brief

Monitor whether the architecture achieves its intended business value. Consider governance requests, technology developments and business-environment changes. Manage change coherently and decide when another cycle is justified. Use performance and capacity information, distinguishing architecture changes from changes to underlying solutions or operational context.

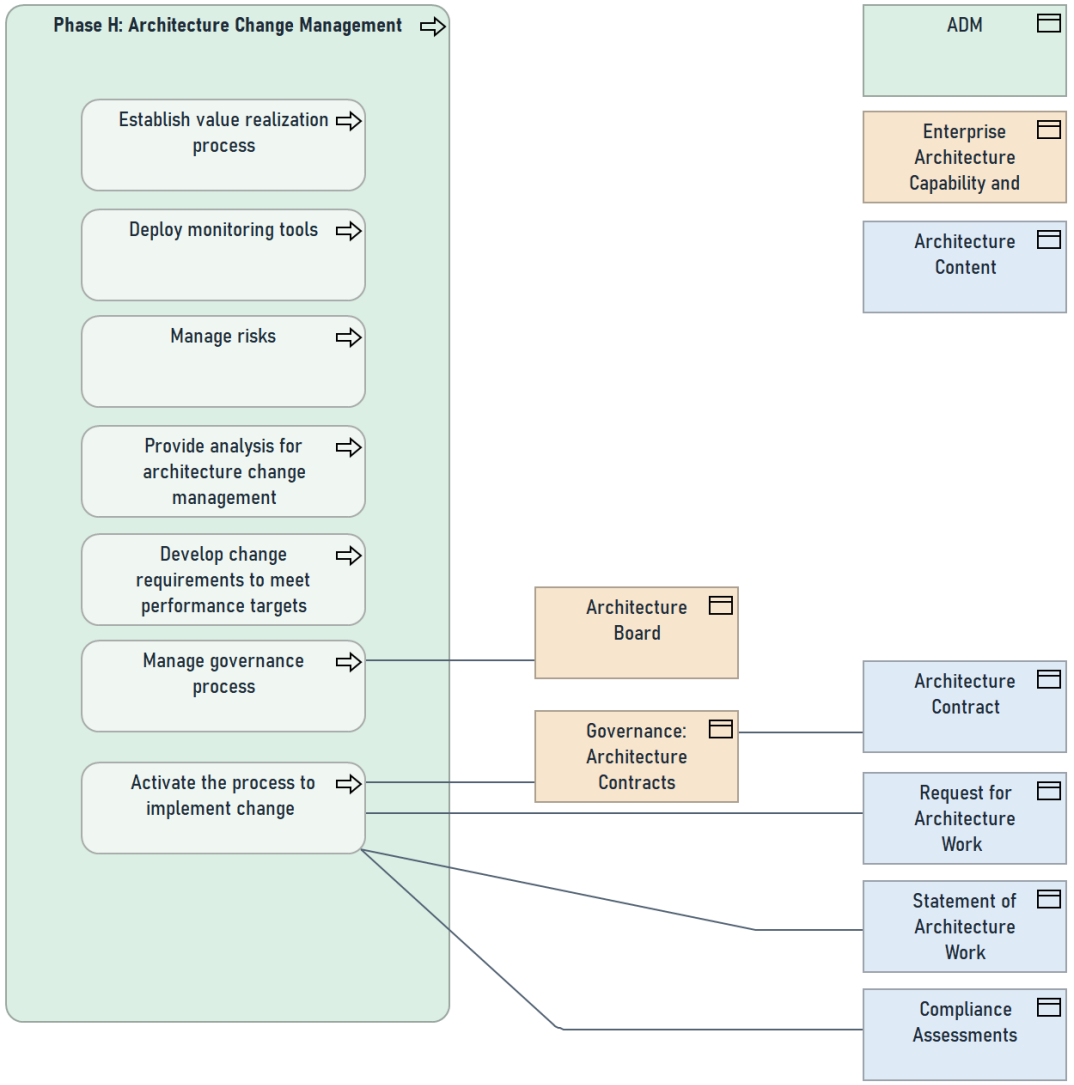
Architecture Change Management | Inputs, steps and outputs

Read from inputs through the phase steps to outputs. Colours identify roles within this view.



Architecture Change Management | Relationships

Follow the modelled connections to related techniques, content and governance. Colours identify books.



Requirements Management

Maintain the requirements that guide architecture work across all relevant phases.

Official objectives

• Ensure that the Requirements Management process is sustained and operates for all relevant ADM phases

• Manage architecture requirements identified during any execution of the ADM cycle or a phase

• Ensure that relevant architecture requirements are available for use by each phase as the phase is executed

Purpose

Essential output and outcome

Maintained requirements and impact information available to relevant ADM phases, connecting new and changed needs to the architecture work.

Essential knowledge

Know approved requirements, their status and change impacts. Distinguish requirements for the current Statement of Architecture Work from those for other work or future cycles.

Approach in brief

Treat requirements as a dynamic process feeding phases and ADM cycles. Record them in a repository, supported by specifications and impact assessments. Each phase selects approved requirements and updates their status. The management process maintains requirements; disposition, resolution and prioritisation occur within the relevant ADM phase.

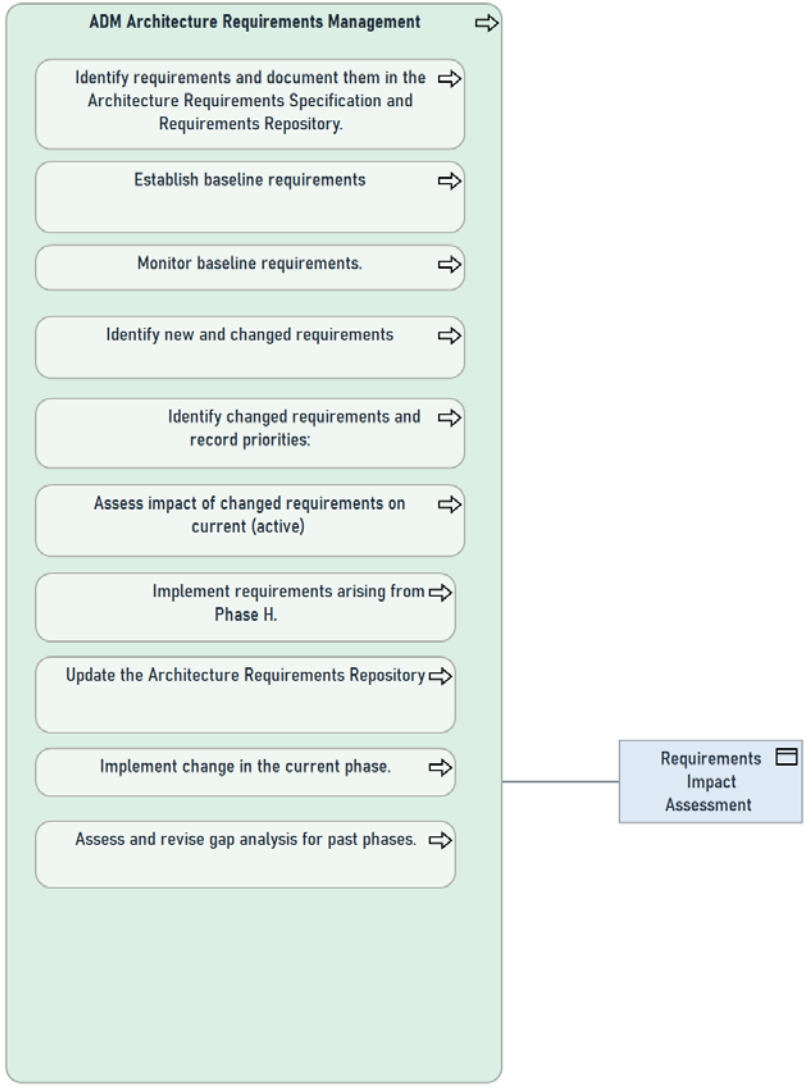
Requirements Management | Inputs, steps and outputs

Read from inputs through the phase steps to outputs. Colours identify roles within this view.



Requirements Management | Relationships

Follow the modelled connections to related techniques, content and governance. Colours identify books.



FROM ONE PHASE TO THE NEXT

Connecting the work

Architecture content develops across the cycle, while requirements and governance keep the work connected.

Follow the recurring content

The Architecture Vision establishes direction. The Architecture Definition Document develops the architecture descriptions. The Architecture Requirements Specification captures the requirements the architecture must address. Roadmap components identified across the domains are consolidated into a roadmap and migration plan.

Connect architecture to delivery

Phase E coordinates the candidate changes and identifies a route towards the target. Phase F refines priorities and the plan. Phase G governs implementation against architecture expectations. Phase H monitors change and continued value. These responsibilities interact with established portfolio, programme and delivery processes.

Recognise the repeated pattern

Business, Data, Application and Technology Architecture share a recognisable pattern: select viewpoints and reference material, understand baseline and target, analyse gaps, consider roadmap components, resolve impacts and review. The subject changes, but the disciplines remain connected.

Use three review questions

What stakeholder concern or requirement justifies this decision? Where is the decision recorded in the architecture content? What later work depends on it? Follow the answer across the phase views and revisit earlier work when an assumption changes.

REFERENCE AND TERMINOLOGY

Sources

Use the relevant TOGAF® publication for the full descriptions, definitions and guidance.

Objectives and approach

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Objectives are quoted from the ADM; approaches summarise its Approach sections. Section pairs (objectives / approach):

Preliminary 2.1 / 2.5; A 3.1 / 3.5; B 4.1 / 4.5; C Data 6.1 / 6.5; C Application 7.1 / 7.5; D 8.1 / 8.5; E 9.1 / 9.5; F 10.1 / 10.5; G 11.1 / 11.5; H 12.1 / 12.5; Requirements Management 13.1 / 13.5.

Essential output, outcome and knowledge

A Practitioners' Approach to Developing Enterprise Architecture Following the TOGAF® ADM (G186), §5.2.2, Table 5-2, printed pp. 47-48. © 2018-2025 The Open Group. All rights reserved.

Wording for A-H is reproduced verbatim, with line wrapping normalised. B, C and D share one row. Preliminary and Requirements Management are absent from that table; their purpose summaries derive from ADM §§2.1/2.4/2.5 and §§13.1-13.5 respectively.

Diagram sources and notices

The supplied DOCK ArchiMate model, based on the ADM, ADM Techniques, Applying the ADM, Architecture Content, and Enterprise Architecture Capability and Governance.

Series Guides shown: Business Scenarios; Customer Master Data Management; Metadata Management; Business Intelligence & Analytics.

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G186 Table 5-2, note [5]

Do not fixate on definition of the term "project" or what a project is. It is just an organizing effort for work to achieve an understood outcome. Your organization's internal definition of a project, and the label used, will be unlikely to align with anyone else's. My assistant refers to booking a flight as a project.

About this companion

Official objectives and essential purpose text are quoted as identified here. Preliminary and Requirements Management purpose text and all approach summaries are by Dock Consulting. This is an independent visual companion, not official TOGAF® Documentation. TOGAF® and ArchiMate are registered trademarks of The Open Group.

The cover and back feature an AI-generated city-and-infrastructure render created for this guide.

A SHARED VOCABULARY

Key terms

Use these short reminders alongside the definitions and guidance in the TOGAF® publications.

Stakeholders and concerns

Stakeholders have interests in the architecture or its outcomes. Their concerns identify matters the architecture must address.

Baseline and target

The baseline describes the relevant current state. The target describes the state sought within the scope of the architecture work.

Gaps and work packages

Gaps identify differences to be addressed. Work packages group the changes needed to move towards the target.

Architecture requirements

Requirements express needs and constraints that the architecture must address. Their status and effects are managed across the relevant phases.

Transition Architecture

An architecturally significant intermediate state between baseline and target, supporting an incremental route to change.

Architecture Roadmap

The work packages and their timing that provide a route towards the Target Architecture.

Implementation and Migration Plan

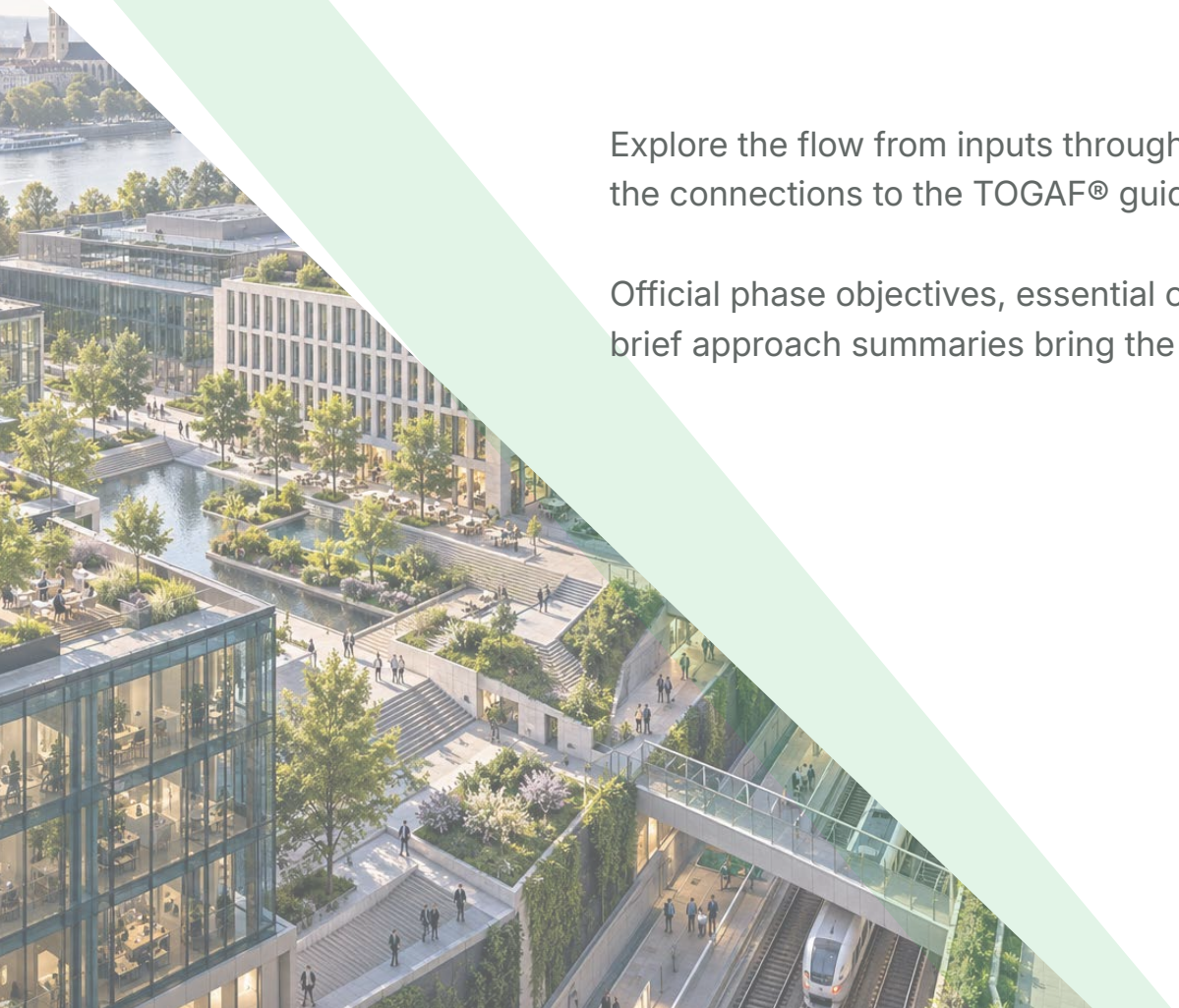
The coordinated implementation schedule and project detail used to realise the planned architecture change.

Value realisation

The value actually achieved through change, considered against the approved target and stakeholder expectations.

DOCK CONSULTING

See how the ADM fits together



Explore the flow from inputs through architecture activities to outputs, then follow the connections to the TOGAF® guidance that supports the work.

Official phase objectives, essential outputs and outcomes, required knowledge and brief approach summaries bring the ADM and its supporting guidance together.

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